

PHASE 1: IDEATION PHASE

EMPATHY MAP CANVAS

Date	28 February 2026
Team ID	LTVIP2026TMIDS76950
Team Size	4
Team Leader	Suresh Kumar V
Team Members	Vemanaboina Lakshmi Prasanna Chengalaraya Akhil Prasad Chittipothula
Project Name	HouseHunt: Finding Your Perfect Rental Home

EMPATHY MAP 1: PROPERTY OWNER

USER PERSONA

Name: Rajesh Kumar

Age: 42

Occupation: Business Owner

Location: Urban area

Tech Savviness: Moderate

Goal: Rent out 3 residential properties efficiently

WHAT DO THEY THINK & FEEL?

Thoughts:

- "I need reliable tenants who will take care of my property"
- "Brokers charge too much (10-15% of annual rent)"
- "I don't have time to manage property showings and paperwork"
- "How can I trust someone I meet online?"
- "I need a professional way to showcase my properties"
- "Rent collection every month is a hassle"

Feelings:

- Frustrated with current broker-dependent system
- Worried about property damage by unreliable tenants
- Anxious about vacancy periods and lost income
- Hopeful about digital solutions

- Concerned about online fraud
- Overwhelmed by administrative tasks

Aspirations:

- Find quality tenants quickly
- Minimize vacancy time
- Save on broker commissions
- Manage properties efficiently
- Build passive income stream
- Professional property presentation

Pain Points:

- High brokerage fees eating into profits
- Time-consuming tenant screening process
- Limited reach to potential renters
- Manual paperwork and documentation
- Difficulty in verifying tenant credibility
- Slow response from brokers

WHAT DO THEY SEE?

In Their Environment:

- Competitors listing properties on multiple platforms
- Successful property rental platforms in other cities
- Advertisements for broker services
- Social media property groups
- Classified ad websites with mixed quality listings
- Digital payment solutions becoming popular

In the Market:

- Growing demand for rental properties
- Other owners using WhatsApp for property promotion
- Technology adoption in real estate
- Online property portals with high commission
- Renters preferring online search

Influencers:

- Other property owners (peer recommendations)
 - Real estate agents and brokers
 - Online reviews and testimonials
 - Tech-savvy family members
 - Business associates
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WHAT DO THEY SAY & DO?**Public Statements:**

- "I need to find good tenants fast"
- "Brokers charge too much for basic services"
- "Is there a way to list properties online for free?"
- "I want direct contact with renters"
- "How do I verify if someone is reliable?"

Actions:

- Lists properties with multiple brokers
- Responds to inquiry calls at odd hours
- Manually maintains tenant records
- Visits property for every viewing
- Negotiates with brokers for lower commission
- Checks classified websites daily
- Uses WhatsApp for property promotion

Behaviours:

- Hesitant to fully trust online platforms initially
 - Prefers phone calls over emails
 - Values word-of-mouth recommendations
 - Willing to learn new technology if beneficial
 - Cost-conscious about marketing expenses
 - Proactive in property maintenance
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WHAT DO THEY HEAR?

From Friends/Family:

- "You should try online property websites"
- "Be careful of online fraud"
- "Make sure to verify tenants properly"
- "Digital platforms are the future"

From Brokers:

- "We have a large network of clients"
- "Our commission is standard in the market"
- "We handle all the paperwork for you"
- "Finding good tenants takes time"

From Colleagues:

- "I listed my property online and found a tenant in 2 weeks"
- "Online platforms save a lot of money"
- "You need to be tech-savvy to use these platforms"
- "Admin approval takes time but ensures quality"

From Media:

- Digital real estate transformation stories
- Success stories of online property platforms
- Warnings about online fraud in rentals
- Benefits of direct owner-renter interaction

PAINS (FRUSTRATIONS)**Top Frustrations:**

1. **High Costs:** 10-15% brokerage fees significantly reduce profit
2. **Time Investment:** Multiple property showings, calls, paperwork
3. **Vacancy Losses:** Every month of vacancy is lost income
4. **Unreliable Brokers:** Slow response, poor tenant screening
5. **Limited Control:** No direct communication with potential tenants
6. **Administrative Burden:** Rent tracking, maintenance requests, documentation
7. **Trust Issues:** Difficulty verifying tenant reliability
8. **Limited Reach:** Local broker networks have limited coverage

Obstacles:

- Lack of technical expertise for online platforms
 - Fear of online fraud
 - Time required to manage online presence
 - Competition from professional landlords
 - Legal complexities in rental agreements
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GAINS (DESIRES)**What Would Make Them Happy:**

1. **Direct Communication:** Speak directly with potential tenants
2. **Cost Savings:** Eliminate or reduce broker fees
3. **Quick Rentals:** Find tenants within 2-3 weeks
4. **Verified Tenants:** Platform-verified, trustworthy renters
5. **Professional Presentation:** Showcase properties with photos and details
6. **Time Savings:** Automated inquiry handling and booking
7. **Transparency:** Clear communication throughout the process
8. **Quality Platform:** Spam-free, verified listings only

Success Metrics:

- Property rented within 3 weeks
 - Saving 10-15% on broker fees
 - Reliable tenant for long-term rental
 - Minimal time investment
 - Professional property showcase
 - Direct tenant communication
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EMPATHY MAP 2: PROPERTY RENTER**USER PERSONA**

Name: Priya Sharma

Age: 28

Occupation: Software Engineer

Location: Moving to new city

Tech Savviness: High

Goal: Find a safe, affordable 2BHK apartment near workplace

WHAT DO THEY THINK & FEEL?

Thoughts:

- "I hope I don't get scammed by fake listings"
- "Why do I have to pay broker fees when I found the property myself?"
- "I want to see actual photos, not photoshopped images"
- "Direct contact with the owner would make this so much easier"
- "I don't have time to visit 20 different properties"
- "How do I know if the neighbourhood is safe?"

Feelings:

- Excited about moving to a new city
- Anxious about finding the right property
- Frustrated with opaque rental processes
- Overwhelmed by too many options without proper filters
- Suspicious of too-good-to-be-true listings
- Stressed about broker fees and hidden costs
- Hopeful about online platforms

Aspirations:

- Find a property close to workplace (save commute time)
- Affordable rent within budget
- Safe and secure neighborhood
- Honest and responsive landlord
- Transparent rental process
- Move-in ready apartment

Pain Points:

- High broker fees (equivalent to one month's rent)
- Time-consuming property search across multiple platforms
- Fake listings and fraud
- Hidden costs revealed only during final agreement
- Difficulty reaching property owners directly
- Misleading property descriptions

WHAT DO THEY SEE?

In Their Environment:

- Colleagues finding properties online
- Multiple property portals with varied quality
- Social media property groups
- Classified ad websites
- WhatsApp property forwarding chains
- Digital payment apps

In the Market:

- Increasing rental prices
- Competition for good properties
- Professional listings with virtual tours
- Broker-dominated rental market
- Growing trend of online property search
- Reviews and ratings for properties

Influencers:

- Friends who recently moved
- Online reviews and testimonials
- Social media recommendations
- Colleagues' experiences
- Family advice
- YouTube property search guides

WHAT DO THEY SAY & DO?

Public Statements:

- "I need a 2BHK near my office under ₹25,000"
- "Are there any no-brokerage property websites?"
- "How do I verify if this listing is real?"
- "Can I talk directly to the owner?"
- "Why should I pay broker fees for an online listing?"

Actions:

- Browses multiple property websites daily
- Saves interesting listings
- Compares properties on spreadsheet
- Calls listed numbers to inquire
- Visits properties on weekends
- Reads reviews and testimonials
- Shares property links with family for advice
- Uses Google Maps to check neighbourhood
- Searches for property on multiple platforms

Behaviours:

- Prefers digital communication (WhatsApp, email)
 - Values transparency and detailed information
 - Willing to pay premium for verified listings
 - Researches extensively before decision
 - Trusts peer recommendations
 - Sceptical of brokers
 - Comfortable with online transactions
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WHAT DO THEY HEAR?**From Friends:**

- "I found my apartment on this website"
- "Always visit the property in person"
- "Negotiate the rent, don't accept first offer"
- "Check for hidden charges in the agreement"
- "Be careful of advance payment scams"

From Brokers:

- "I have the perfect property for you"
- "You need to pay brokerage for my services"
- "This property will go fast, decide quickly"
- "Visit fees may apply for property viewing"

From Colleagues:

- "Use online platforms, they're more transparent"
- "Direct owner contact saves brokerage"
- "Read all reviews before committing"
- "Always get a receipt for any payment"

From Family:

- "Safety is more important than rent savings"
- "Make sure the landlord seems trustworthy"
- "Check water supply and electricity backup"
- "Visit the neighborhood at different times"

PAINS (FRUSTRATIONS)

Top Frustrations:

1. **Broker Fees:** 10-15% or one month rent for minimal service
2. **Fake Listings:** Wasted time visiting non-existent or misrepresented properties
3. **Hidden Costs:** Undisclosed charges revealed at signing
4. **Search Inefficiency:** Too many platforms to check
5. **Lack of Filters:** Can't narrow down by specific requirements
6. **No Owner Contact:** Always mediated through brokers
7. **Information Gaps:** Incomplete or misleading descriptions
8. **Time Waste:** Multiple property visits for unsuitable options

Obstacles:

- Limited time for property search (working professional)
- Unfamiliar with new city layout
- Trust issues with online listings
- Pressure to find property quickly
- Competition from other renters

GAINS (DESIRES)

What Would Make Them Happy:

1. **Zero Brokerage:** Direct owner contact

2. **Verified Listings:** Authentic, spam-free properties
3. **Detailed Information:** Photos, amenities, nearby facilities
4. **Advanced Filters:** By location, price, type, amenities
5. **Quick Search:** Find property within 1 week
6. **Transparency:** All costs disclosed upfront
7. **Easy Booking:** Simple online booking process
8. **Direct Communication:** Owner's contact information

Success Metrics:

- Find suitable property within 1 week
 - Save ₹15,000-20,000 in broker fees
 - All information available online
 - Direct owner communication
 - Move in within 2 weeks
 - No hidden surprises
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EMPATHY MAP 3: PLATFORM ADMINISTRATOR

USER PERSONA

Name: Amit Patel

Age: 35

Occupation: Platform Manager

Tech Savviness: High

Goal: Maintain platform quality and user satisfaction

WHAT DO THEY THINK & FEEL?

Thoughts:

- "We need to prevent spam and fake listings"
- "How can we verify owner authenticity efficiently?"
- "User trust is our biggest asset"
- "Platform quality directly impacts reputation"
- "We need to scale without compromising quality"

Feelings:

- Responsible for platform integrity
- Concerned about fraudulent activities

- Proud when users succeed
- Stressed during platform issues
- Motivated by positive user feedback

Aspirations:

- Build most trusted property platform
- Achieve 99% user satisfaction
- Zero tolerance for fraud
- Seamless user experience
- Scalable platform growth

Pain Points:

- Manual verification time-consuming
- Balancing speed with quality
- Handling user disputes
- Maintaining platform uptime
- Managing fraudulent attempts

WHAT DO THEY SEE?

- Platform usage metrics and analytics
- User feedback and complaints
- Competitor platforms' features
- Fraud attempts and spam submissions
- Successful bookings and positive outcomes
- Technical performance dashboards

WHAT DO THEY SAY & DO?

Actions:

- Reviews owner registration requests daily
- Monitors platform for suspicious activities
- Responds to user support queries
- Analyzes platform metrics
- Approves/rejects owner applications

- Reviews reported listings
- Updates platform policies

Statements:

- "Quality over quantity always"
 - "Every approved owner represents our brand"
 - "User trust is non-negotiable"
 - "We need to maintain verification standards"
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PAINS

- Time-intensive manual verification
 - Difficult to spot sophisticated fraud
 - Scaling verification with growth
 - Handling dispute resolution
 - Balancing owner and renter satisfaction
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GAINS

- Efficient verification process
 - Automated fraud detection
 - High user retention rate
 - Positive reviews and ratings
 - Sustainable platform growth
 - Happy users on both sides
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KEY INSIGHTS FROM EMPATHY MAPPING

Cross-Persona Insights

1. **Trust is Universal:** All personas prioritize trust and verification
2. **Direct Communication Valued:** Both owners and renters want to eliminate intermediaries
3. **Cost Consciousness:** Broker fees are pain point for both sides
4. **Quality over Quantity:** All stakeholders prefer verified, quality interactions
5. **Technology Adoption:** All personas are comfortable with digital solutions
6. **Transparency Needed:** Clear, honest information is essential

7. **Time Constraints:** Everyone values efficiency and speed

Design Implications

Must Include:

- Strong verification system (admin approval)
- Direct owner-renter communication
- Detailed property information with photos
- Advanced filtering capabilities
- Clear, transparent process
- Quick response times
- Mobile-responsive design
- Security features

Must Avoid:

- Complex registration processes
- Hidden fees or surprise charges
- Cluttered interfaces
- Slow load times
- Lack of verification
- Poor quality listings

Document Status: Complete

Date: 28 February 2026
